Crawler Companion Player Guide

Nov 11, 2026 · @Rob

Getting started

The Crawler section is your character manager: link your fillable character sheet PDF, play from the tabs, and every change saves back into the PDF.

1. Open `Crawler_Companion_v1.4.0.html`, or a newer version, in Chrome or Edge and scroll to the **Crawler** section.
2. Pick your Floor at the top of the page. Every Floor-based number on the page follows it.
3. Press **Link your PDF** and choose your fillable character sheet. On your next visit, press **Reconnect** to pick up the same file.
4. Play from the tabs: Check, Damage, Health & Mana, Dice, Skills, Gear, Pet and Notes.
5. Watch the change list under your sheet's name. Each edit shows as a line, like "Inventory: Gold 0 to 400".
6. Press **Save to sheet**, or leave **Save changes automatically** ticked.

- **Reload** reads the PDF again. The page also checks the file every few seconds, so edits made in your PDF reader come through.
- **Unlink** stops using the file. Nothing in it is deleted.
- No sheet linked? Everything still works and is kept in this browser until you link one.
- Hover over or tap any underlined number to see how it was worked out.
- Firefox and Safari open the sheet read-only. The change list then tells you what to update by hand.
- The strip above the tabs shows Health, Mana, AI Favor and your pet's Health at a glance.

Getting updates

The newest version is always on the Releases page, and the page can fetch it for you. The footer shows which version you have.

1. Press **Check for updates** at the bottom of the page. The page only contacts GitHub when you press it.

2. If a newer version is out, read what's new and press **Download**. The file goes to your Downloads folder.
3. Open the new file in place of the old one. In Chrome and Edge your settings come along; press **Reconnect** to relink your sheet.

Your crawler

The Your crawler panel holds the numbers every other tab uses, so keep it current and the rest follows.

- **Unenhanced** is your base plus Race, Class, Stat potions and level-ups. **Enhanced** adds gear, Spells and Buffs.
- Raise an Unenhanced Stat and Enhanced rises by the same amount, so gear and Buff bonuses stay put. Change Enhanced alone for a temporary Buff.
- Gear moves Enhanced only. You never adjust a Stat by hand when you equip something.
- Hover over a Mod to see the Stat behind it and how much comes from gear.
- Below the Stats: Evade Buffs, Armor DR, DR Buffs, AI Favor, Level and Jumping Rank.

Worked-out numbers fill in from those values:

Number	Comes from
Evade	d20 + Dex Mod + Evade Buffs
DR	Armor DR + DR Buffs
Health Bar	10 slots, each worth your Con Mod
Max Mana	Enhanced Intelligence
Hold breath, Dying countdown	Con Mod in rounds
Jump, Lift, Throw	Jumping Rank and Strength
Charisma	Popularity change at the end of the Floor
Stat points	3 per Level past 1, spent in a saferoom from Floor 3

Rolling, damage and healing

Four tabs cover the moment-to-moment play: the Check tab rolls, Damage works out what you deal, Health & Mana tracks what you take, and Dice is a plain roller.

Check

1. Pick a Skill or attack under **From your sheet**. That sets the Stat, Rank and target type, and rolling it ticks the Skill for advancement.
2. Or pick **Skill Check**, **Attack**, **Evade** or **Stat Check** and set the Stat, Rank, Other bonus and Advantage or Disadvantage. Tick **No Ranks** for an untrained roll.
3. Tick any penalties: Minor Injury (-2), Major Injury (-5), Sore as Shit (-1) and Fatigued stacks.
4. Set the target with **Unopposed**, **Stat check** or **Foe or Mob**, plus the foe's Mod and any edge the Mob has.
5. Read your odds, then type your d20 or press **Roll for me**. **Reroll with AI Favor** spends 1 AI Favor.

Other bonus resets to 0 when you switch the kind of roll or pick another Skill, so a one-off bonus never carries over.

Damage

- Pick an attack under **Attack from your sheet**, or set base dice, extra base dice, Stat Mod and a flat bonus.
- Tick **Add Rank damage die** for weapon Skills and pick the result: Hit, Amazing Success or Critical Hit.
- The page shows the dice to roll and why. **Roll for me** rolls them.
- Extra base dice (like Iron Punch's 1d2) double on a Critical Hit. The Rank die doesn't.

Health & Mana

- **Take the hit**: type the damage, then set Resisted, Vulnerable or Immune, an area attack you Evaded or were caught in the Splash of, and whether it came from a Debuff (skips DR). The line below shows how many slots the hit costs before you take it.
- **Heal**, **Cast Heal (2 Mana)** and **Spend Mana** do what they say.
- Rest buttons: **1 calm hour** gives 1 slot and 5 Mana, **Short rest (2 h)** gives 5 slots and half your Mana, **Long rest (8 h)** fills both and clears Fatigued.

Dice

- One-press rolls: d20, d20 with Advantage or Disadvantage, Help 1d2, Help or Intervene 1d6, Call a Play 2d6.
- **Any dice** takes expressions like `3d6+2`.
- **Roll an advancement check** works for any Rank you type in. For Skills on your sheet, use the Skills tab.

Skills

The Skills tab lists every Skill on your sheet with its Rank, its roll bonus (gear included) and its advancement tick, and runs the advancement rules for you.

- **Roll** sends a Skill to the Check tab and ticks it. Passive Skills never tick.
- **Add a Skill** or **Edit**: name, Rank, Stat, what it's rolled against, notes, grind hours, an end-of-floor bonus, and whether it can reach Rank 20. The sheet holds 20 Skills.

Advancement checks

Each ticked Skill rolls a d20, and a roll equal to or over its Rank gives +1 Rank (top Rank 15, or 20 if your Race or Class allows it). Ticks clear afterwards.

1. After each 2 hours of play, press **Every 2 hours**. It rolls ticked Skills at Rank 4 or lower.
2. At the end of a Floor, press **End of floor**. It rolls every ticked Skill.
3. Humans pick one Skill at Rank 9 or less to roll with Advantage at the end of the Floor.

Untrained Skills

- Type the Skill under **Try a Skill you don't have**, pick its Stat and press **Roll it untrained**. It rolls with Disadvantage and no Rank.
- On Floors 1 and 2 the Skill goes on your sheet at Rank 0 and ticked. At the next 2-hour check you pick one of the Skills you tried to learn at Rank 1.
- From Floor 3, trying a Skill no longer teaches it.

Grinding

- Enter the hours, any map bonus (Neighborhood Map +1 or Borough Field Guide +2 at 5 or more hours) and which Skills you trained, then **Log the grind**.

- A Skill rolls its advancement check as soon as its grind hours reach its Rank. Each Skill grinds once a day.
- 5 hours a day is safe. Each hour past 5 needs an Endurance check.
- Grind hours also count toward your next Level: grind as many hours as your Level and you gain one.

Grind hours, the end-of-floor bonus and Rank 20 are saved at the end of the Skill's notes on your sheet, like `Grind 2 h; Adv +1; Max 20`.

Gear

The Gear tab manages what you wear and carry, and equipping an item moves your Enhanced Stats, Armor DR and Evade Buffs by its bonus (and back when you take it off).

Gear Slots

- One item each for Head, Torso, Arms, Legs and Feet.
- Hands/Holding splits into Gloves, Main hand and Off hand. A two-handed item takes both hands and sends what you were holding back to your Inventory.
- Accessories hold up to 10, with one belt and one cape.
- **Unequip** puts an item back in your Inventory. **Edit** changes its name or bonuses while you wear it.

Adding and equipping items

1. Press **Add an item**. Give it a name, how many, its Gear Slot, and its bonuses: All Stats, single Stats, Armor DR, Evade, and Skills written like `+2 Investigation, +1 Dodge`.
2. For a potion or other consumable, set **Use** to heal slots, Mana, full Health or full Mana.
3. Press **Save**. The item lands in your Inventory.
4. Press **Equip**. An item with no Gear Slot gets an **Equip to** menu instead.

On your sheet, an item's slot, bonuses and use are written at the start of its Inventory notes, like `Head: +2 Int, DR 1. Use: full Mana.`, so they come back next time.

Inventory

- Your sheet has 20 Inventory rows. Gold and Misc. Junk take one each.
- **Search**, **Sort** (sheet order, A to Z, quantity) and filter by kind: Weapons, Wearables, Accessories, Consumables, Scrolls, Loot Boxes and Other.

- The minus and plus buttons change an amount. Dropping to 0 asks before it removes the row.
- **Use** drinks a potion or uses an item, healing or restoring Mana, and reminds you about Potion Sickness.

Gold, Junk and looting

- Type a number into **Gold** or **Misc. Junk** to set it, or `+50` to add and `-20` to spend.
- **Sell all junk** turns every Misc. Junk into 1 gold.
- Set **Bodies** and press **Loot them**. It rolls the Floor's gold dice and 1d6 Misc. Junk for each body. Floor 1 Mobs drop no gold.

Hotlist

Ten boxes for the Spells and items you can use with one Action. Spells must be here to cast them in combat.

Loading from CrawlerForge

Load from CrawlerForge (Gear tab) reads a CrawlerForge file and brings its gear, Inventory, unopened Loot Boxes, Gold, Junk and Hotlist into your sheet. It reads three kinds of file:

File	Made in CrawlerForge with	Looks like	What you get
Crawler	Open the Crawler, **Manage**, **Export this Crawler**	`crawler-rob-20261105.json`	That crawler's gear, Inventory, Loot Boxes, Gold, Junk and Hotlist
Backup	**Account**, Data card, **Export everything**	`crawlerforge-everything-20261105.json`	Pick one crawler, or your Forge
Pack	A pack's page, **Export**	`pack-sponsor-bait.json`	Tick the items and Loot Boxes you want

Load your crawler

1. Export your crawler from CrawlerForge (see the table).

2. In Crawler Companion's Gear tab, press **Load from CrawlerForge** and choose the file.
3. Read the preview: what's worn, what's carried, how many unopened Loot Boxes, Gold, Junk and the Hotlist. From a backup, pick the crawler first.
4. Untick what you don't want: **Gear and Inventory**, **Gold and Misc. Junk**, **Hotlist**.
5. Press **Load it**. Your Enhanced Stats, Armor DR and Evade Buffs move by the gear bonus, just as if you'd equipped it by hand.

- Loading the same file twice doesn't count bonuses twice.
- Gear Slots that are empty in CrawlerForge keep what's on your sheet. Tick **Also empty the Gear Slots that are empty in CrawlerForge** to clear them.
- An item with no notes in CrawlerForge keeps your sheet's notes for an item of the same name.
- A Hotlist entry keeps your sheet's wording when it starts with the same name, so "Soul Collector: 4 Mana, 50 ft" isn't cut down to "Soul Collector".
- Anything you undid in CrawlerForge is left out.
- The sheet only has 20 Inventory rows. The preview lists anything that won't fit.
- Crafting, alchemy and enchanting aren't replayed yet. The preview warns you when the file has them.

Add from a pack or your Forge

1. Press **Load from CrawlerForge** and choose a pack file, or a backup and then **Your Forge** in the picker.
2. Tick the items and Loot Boxes you want.
3. Press **Add to Inventory**. Nothing you already carry is replaced.

Item effects become bonuses and uses where the sheet has them (Stats, All Stats, Skill Ranks, DR, Evade, healing and Mana). Anything else, like Move, extra damage or a percentage Stat bonus, goes into the item's notes in plain words.

Loot Boxes

A Loot Box waits in your Inventory until you press **Open**, and opening it puts everything inside straight onto your sheet.

Getting boxes in

1. Your GM awards a box in CrawlerForge (or you earn one from an Achievement). It shows on your CrawlerForge sheet as waiting in your Gear.
2. Leave it unopened. Export your crawler: open the Crawler, **Manage**, **Export this Crawler**.
3. In Crawler Companion's Gear tab, press **Load from CrawlerForge**, choose the file and press **Load it**.
4. The preview counts your unopened Loot Boxes, and each one becomes an Inventory row.

If your GM sends a pack file instead, load it the same way, tick the boxes and press **Add to Inventory**.

A box you already opened in CrawlerForge doesn't come across as a box. Its items, Gold and Junk come across as part of your Inventory instead, less any tithe your deity took.

What a box row shows

- Chips for **Loot Box**, its tier, and **Random** if it's a random box.
- What it holds, like "Holds 400 Gold; Enchanted Armguards [Arms, DR 2]; Standard Mana Potion x3; Skill Potion +1 (your pick)."
- Filter your Inventory by **Loot Boxes** to see them all.

Opening a box

1. Press **Open** on the box's row. The panel lists everything inside.
2. If a Skill or Stat potion says "your pick", choose the Skill or Stat in the panel. Type a Skill you don't have yet and it's added.
3. Press **Open it**. The message under the Gear Slots lists what came out and every roll.

Inside the box	What Open does
An item	Adds it to your Inventory with its bonuses and use, ready to equip
Gold or Misc. Junk	Rolls the dice (like `1d10x100`) and adds the total
Skill potion	Raises that Skill by its Ranks, up to Rank 15 (20 if the Skill can reach it)

Inside the box	What Open does
Stat potion	Raises that Stat's Unenhanced and Enhanced together
A Skill at a Rank	Adds the Skill, or raises it if yours is lower
Text	Shows in the message

- **Potion limit:** a crawler can only ever drink two Stat potions and two Skill potions (Core p. 226). The panel warns you before a third, but lets you open the box.
- **Full Inventory:** if what's inside won't fit in your 20 rows, nothing happens and the panel tells you to make room.
- **Random boxes** from a pack only roll their Gold here. The panel says how many items, consumables and potions your GM rolls for the rest (Core p. 219). A box your GM awards in CrawlerForge is already rolled, so it opens in full.
- By the book, you open Loot Boxes in a saferoom.

On your sheet, a box's notes start with `Loot Box:` and list what's inside. Typed in that wording by hand, it still opens.

Pet and Notes

Pet

The Pet tab runs the pet and mount boxes from page 5 of your sheet. One pet per crawler unless your Class says otherwise.

1. With no pet on your sheet, give it a **Name** and **Starting attitude** and press **Add a Level 1 pet**.
2. Fill in its Stats, Level, DR, Evade, Move and Size, and pick its **Role**: Tank, Aggressive or Utility. Its Mods work themselves out.
3. **Level up with the party** levels it, and the page shows Stat points to place. Press **Points placed** when you've spent them.

- **Health Bar:** slots start at the pet's Size and gain 1 per level, up to 10. Each slot holds its Con Mod. Use **Take the hit**, **Heal** and **Full Health**.
- **Attacks:** two attack boxes, each with **Roll**. Pet attacks roll at Rank equal to the Floor.
- **Command it to fight** rolls your Animal Handling against 10 + Floor + the pet's Int Mod. **Change its attitude** rolls to move it between Hostile, Calm, Friendly and Bonded.

- Name, attitude and role are saved at the start of the pet's Special box, like `Jane, Bonded, Utility.`
- **Mount or vehicle** holds Size, Move, DR, Occupants, Accessories and its own Health Bar. Mounts don't level up.

Notes

Every story and notes box on your sheet, in one place: Notes, Past Trauma, Loose Ends, Regrets and Popularity. Open **More from your sheet** for kills, clubs, deity, racial and class abilities, Sponsors and your personal space.

- Lists take one entry per line. The number beside a box, like Important things I've killed (13), is how many lines your sheet holds, and the page warns you when you go over.
- The PDF's boxes are small, so long text is all saved but your PDF reader may only show the start of it.

Good to know

Your sheet holds almost everything, so the PDF is your save file. A few extras live only in the browser you use:

- Hours ground toward your next Level.
- A pet's Stat points not yet placed.
- Your notes on an item while you're wearing it. They go back into its Inventory notes when you take it off.
- The full contents of a Loot Box. On another computer, the box opens from the wording in its notes instead.
- How many Stat and Skill potions you've drunk, for the two-of-each warning.

Problem	Fix
Changes won't save to the PDF	Use Chrome or Edge. Firefox and Safari can only read the sheet.
"doesn't look like a CrawlerForge crawler, backup or pack"	Pick the `.json` file CrawlerForge exported, not the PDF sheet.
A box or item is missing after loading	The Inventory may be full (20 rows). Check the preview's warning, make room, and load again.

Problem	Fix
An item in a box says "An item the pack no longer holds"	Ask your GM to put the item in the same pack as the box and export it again.
Stats look off after equipping	Hover over the Stat's Mod. It shows how much comes from gear and how much from other Buffs.